



CLIENT TRAINING · ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT · BRAND FOUNDATION

Know the Field. Own Your Ground.

Competitive Positioning in Verilume: why naming five competitors once sharpens every piece of copy after, what the Battle Briefs and AI research give you, and the six steps to an approved positioning that the platform never has to ask about again.

Read time: 12 minutes · Setup time: 30–40 minutes · Payback: the next campaign and every one after

SESSION ONE

Positioning is a decision, not a paragraph

Ask a room of marketers who their competitors are and you'll get a confident answer. Ask them *why a customer chooses the other guy* and the room goes quiet. That gap — between knowing the names and knowing the choice — is where positioning actually lives, and it's the gap most brands never close because nobody writes it down.

Competitive Positioning is the page where you close it. Up to five competitors, each with a plain-language note on why they compete for the same customer. An Industry Trends read of the category. From those, the platform builds a Strategic Opportunity synthesis and a Battle Brief per competitor, runs multi-model AI research on each one, and — this is the part that matters — carries the positioning into every campaign, voice guide and press release from then on, without ever naming a competitor in your copy.

It is also the third of the three Brand Foundation approvals, alongside Voice and Colors & Fonts. Until it's saved, the platform won't let you create your first campaign. That's deliberate: copy written without a point of view is copy anyone could have written.

What changes when positioning is approved

Before	After
The AI writes in your voice but with no point of view about the category.	Copy carries your differentiation — implicitly, never by naming a competitor.
Competitor knowledge lives with two people.	Battle Briefs and side-by-side tables anyone on the team can open.
"What are they doing?" is a research project.	Twelve research themes per competitor, run on demand across several AI models, with live-web findings labelled as such.
Positioning drifts as people change.	Every approved version is kept; restore any earlier one in a click.
You can't create a campaign yet.	The gate opens.

The stakes

Every campaign is a claim about why you and not them. If that claim isn't written down, the AI can't make it, your agency can't make it, and your customers will make it for you — usually on price. Thirty minutes here is how you keep that decision in your hands.

SESSION TWO

What's in the box

Seven modules on one page. Two are inputs you write; the rest are built from them.

Module	What it is	Your part
Industry Trends	An editable read of your category. Generate draft → writes a first pass from known category patterns — reasoning, not live market data — for you to correct.	Edit it until it's true.
Direct Competitors	Up to five companies. Each has a name, a "Why they compete for the same customer" note (auto-drafted when you leave the name field, if empty), an optional reference file, and twelve research theme chips.	Name them, fix the notes, run the themes you care about.
Strategic Opportunity	A live synthesis of your Promise-Delivery Map placement, the Industry Trends text and your competitors. Refresh view → rebuilds it; it isn't saved separately.	Read it; it's a mirror.
Battle Brief	With one competitor: a detailed brief. With two or more: a side-by-side table above the individual briefs. With none: your own positioning.	Share it with sales and creative.
Current Activity	A feed of competitor moves, each linked to the workstream it affects (Search Optimization or Reputation).	Scan weekly.
Specialty Partners	The paid tier for Reddit-at-volume and TV/broadcast monitoring.	Optional.
Version history	Every approved version, with Reference / Applied / Removed (a reason is required to remove).	Keep the current one marked.

The twelve research themes

Each competitor has a row of chips: **Marketing & Positioning** (the default), Strategic Rationale, Market Position, Financial Health, Growth Trajectory, Operational / Integration Risk, Technology / IP, Customer & Brand, Leadership / Culture, Legal / Regulatory, Deal Structure and Post-Close. Pressing one runs real AI research across several models — about 30 seconds — and saves the result to that competitor. Findings from the one model with live web search are tagged "Live web-checked"; everything else is labelled "AI reasoning — no live public data found," so you always know which is which.

One theme feeds your voice. The rest feed you.

Only the Marketing & Positioning theme — its why-they-compete, market-overlap and marketing-approach fields — reaches the Voice Guide and Voice Contest. The other eleven are for your own strategic reading. Run Marketing & Positioning on every competitor; run the others where you're curious.

SESSION THREE

The six steps to approved positioning

Path: Account Management → Brand Foundation → Competitive Positioning ("Initial setup — ongoing tracking lives in Strategy"), or Next from Website Examples in the Configuration sequence. Also reachable from AI Agent Training → Research.

01 Write the category before the competitors

Under Industry Trends press **Generate draft** →, then edit hard. The draft is a reasonable read of your category's known patterns; your job is to add what only you know — the shift in your customer, the pricing pressure, the channel that stopped working. Two honest paragraphs beat six generic ones.

02 Name up to five — and choose them for overlap, not size

Press + **Add a competitor**. The right five are the ones your customer actually considers alongside you, not the biggest names in the category. When you leave the name field, the "Why they compete for the same customer" note is drafted for you; rewrite it in your words. The best notes contain an explicit edge — "...our edge is the onboard program, theirs is price" — because a note with an explicit "edge is" phrase is what the campaign copy can build on.

03 Attach evidence the right way

Each competitor can take a reference file (.txt, .md, .docx, .doc, .pdf, .png, .jpg). Text from .txt and .md files is added to the note; every other format is recorded by filename only. So if the useful detail is in a PDF or a deck, paste the relevant lines into the note field — that's what the AI reads.

04 Run Marketing & Positioning on every competitor

Press the **Marketing & Positioning** chip for each one. Wait for the result (up to ~30 seconds; it needs a company name and a live connection). Results save automatically and don't change approval status. Then run any other themes you're curious about — Financial Health and Growth Trajectory are the ones leadership usually asks for.

05 Read the Battle Brief and Strategic Opportunity

Press **Refresh view** → on Strategic Opportunity and read it as a stranger would. Open the Battle Brief; with two or more competitors the side-by-side table is the fastest sanity check you'll get on whether your differentiation is real. If the brief could describe a competitor as easily as you, go back to step 2 and sharpen the notes.

06 Save — mark approved

One button, **Save — mark approved** →, and it does exactly that: saving is approving, and the page becomes live context immediately. The only requirement is Industry Trends text or at least one named competitor. Then **Next: Marketing Budget Upload** →.

The gate.

Create Campaign checks Voice, then Colors & Fonts, then Positioning, and sends you to the first one missing. It only applies until your first real (non-Ad-Hoc) campaign exists. The Create Campaign form shows a banner ahead of time so nobody is surprised.

SESSION FOUR

Where positioning shows up

Feature	What it reads from Competitive Positioning
Voice Guide and Voice Contest	The Marketing & Positioning theme only; instructed never to name a competitor.
Campaign long-form copy	Each competitor's name and note as internal context; the "What sets this apart..." line when positioning is approved and a note contains an explicit "edge is" phrase.
PR / Corporate Communications	Competitor names and notes as internal context.
Continuous competitor monitoring (paid tier)	The competitor list and Industry Trends; "worth watching" items feed the Battle Brief, the Daily Brief and the Client Competitors curated-news category.
Search Everywhere keyword ideas	"[You] vs [Competitor]" comparison phrases.
AI Brain inputs audit	Listed under "Key competitors and battle briefs."

Coaching notes from the field

Five is a ceiling, not a target.

Three competitors your customer genuinely weighs against you are worth more than five names from an analyst report. The button disappears at five and the platform keeps only the first five regardless.

Write the edge explicitly.

A note that says "they're bigger" teaches nothing. A note that says "their edge is price and reach; ours is the onboard experience and named guides" gives the copy something to stand on — and is literally what the platform looks for.

Save is approve.

There's no draft state on this page. Whatever you save is live context for the AI immediately. Get the notes right before pressing the button, and use Version history if you need to walk something back.

Trust the labels on research.

"Live web-checked" means a model actually searched the web. "AI reasoning" means it inferred from what it knows. Both are useful; only one is evidence. Don't put an AI-reasoning finding in a board deck without checking it.

Removing a row and saving drops that competitor.

It isn't archived. If you need it back, restore an earlier version from Version history.

SESSION FIVE

Who does what, and your checklist

Role	Owns	When
Marketing leadership	Chooses the five; writes or approves each "why they compete" note; presses Save — mark approved.	Onboarding; revisit when the competitive set changes.
Strategy / insights	Industry Trends text; runs research themes; reads Strategic Opportunity and the Battle Briefs.	Onboarding; quarterly refresh.
Sales enablement	Uses the Battle Brief side-by-side; feeds back objections that should appear in the notes.	Ongoing.
Content / PR	Reads the positioning before drafting; never names competitors in outbound copy.	Every piece.

Setup checklist

Item	Where
Industry Trends drafted and edited to what only you know	Industry Trends
Up to five competitors named, chosen for customer overlap	Direct Competitors
Each note rewritten in your words with an explicit "our edge is..."	Direct Competitors
Key evidence pasted into notes (not just attached as PDF)	Direct Competitors
Marketing & Positioning theme run on every competitor	Research theme chips
Strategic Opportunity refreshed and read	Strategic Opportunity
Battle Brief side-by-side reviewed with sales	Battle Brief
Save — mark approved pressed; current version marked in Version history	Bottom of page
Create Campaign no longer shows the "Brand work isn't complete" banner	Campaign Creation

The closing thought

You will be positioned whether you decide it or not. The only choice is who does the deciding. Five names, five honest notes, one save — and from then on every word the platform writes for you knows exactly where you stand.

Questions or a walkthrough with your team: reach your Verilume account lead.